Inspection Report

Mary Balcom

526 Webster Street
Fairmont, MN 56031

Customer ID: **501581**
Certificate:
Site: 003
Mary Balcom

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION
Date: 19-AUG-2026

2.1(a)(1)

Requirements and application.

The facility is conducting regulated activity without a license from USDA APHIS Animal Care under the Animal Welfare Act (AWA). An inventory from a licensed pet store shows this individual has sold approximately 64 hamsters, 100 guinea pigs, 50 gerbils, and 5 rabbits to the licensee between December 2024 and September 2025. When contacted, the licensee admitted selling hamsters, guinea pigs, gerbils, and rabbits to the licensee. She stated she had ten gerbils last year, but doesn't know how many were female. She also admitted to having 5 female hamsters, 3 female rabbits, and 30 guinea total pigs last year. A search was previously conducted on this individual on 2/19/17. The facility representative was made aware of what is and isn't regulated activity at that time. An application packet was also sent out to the facility representative.

Conducting regulated activity without a USDA license does not allow for the inspection of the regulated animals' health and well-being in accordance with the Animal Welfare Act. Continuing to conduct regulated activity without a license is a serious violation of the Animal Welfare Act. The customer must either stop conducting regulated activity or the customer must obtain a USDA license.

NO REGULATED ACTIVITIES MAY BE CONDUCTED UNTIL A LICENSE IS OBTAINED.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with the facility representative.

You may appeal all or part of any inspection report by submitting a written statement contesting the findings—along with any supporting documentation—to the Deputy Administrator. Appeals of routine, focused, or attempted inspections must be received within 21 days of report issuance as shown by the signature line of this report.

Appeals may be sent by email to AnimalCare@usda.gov.

Appeals sent by mail should be addressed to:
Deputy Administrator
APHIS Animal Care (AC)
U.S. Department of Agriculture

Prepared By: KEVIN WILKEN
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Title: ANIMAL CARE INSPECTOR
Date: 13-OCT-2026

Received by Title: Facility Representative
Date: 13-OCT-2026

Inspection Report

2150 Centre Avenue, Building B
Mailstop #3W11
Fort Collins, CO 80526-8117

Prepared By: KEVIN WILKEN
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Title: ANIMAL CARE INSPECTOR

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United States Department of Agriculture
Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service

Customer: 501581
Inspection Date: 19-Aug-2026

Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
501581		003	Mary Balcom	19-AUG-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000000	NONE	NONE
000000	Total	